Biashara OS

The Operating System for Kenyan SMEs

COMPREHENSIVE BUSINESS PLAN

Zero to Regional Scale — A Complete Roadmap

Version	1.0 — June 2026
Geography	Nairobi → East Africa
Stage	Pre-Revenue / Planning

CONFIDENTIAL

1. EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

Biashara OS is a mobile-first business operating platform purpose-built for small and medium-sized enterprises (SMEs) in Kenya. The platform unifies sales tracking (POS), inventory management, M-Pesa payment reconciliation, receipt generation, business analytics, and loss detection into a single transaction-based architecture.

Kenyan SMEs — bars, hardware stores, pharmacies, retail shops, mini-supermarkets, liquor stores, and agrovet outlets — collectively process millions of transactions daily. Today, the overwhelming majority of these businesses manage their operations through notebooks, WhatsApp messages, loose memory, and manual M-Pesa statement reviews. The result is invisible shrinkage, cash-flow blindness, and lost profit.

Biashara OS replaces this chaos with real-time clarity. Every shilling. Every item. Every transaction. Recorded, reconciled, and reported automatically.

The Opportunity

Total Addressable Market	All SMEs in Kenya — estimated 7.4 million registered businesses
Serviceable Addressable Market	Retail/trade SMEs actively using M-Pesa — est. 1.2 million businesses
Serviceable Obtainable Market (Y1)	Retail SMEs in Nairobi East — Kamulu, Joska, Kangundo Rd corridor
Core Problem	Manual, error-prone business management costing SMEs money daily
Core Solution	Unified transaction platform: POS + Inventory + M-Pesa Reconciliation
Business Model	Monthly SaaS subscription + setup fees + premium modules
Target Revenue — Year 1	KES 600,000 (100 businesses @ avg KES 500/mo)
Target Revenue — Year 5	KES 60,000,000 (10,000 businesses @ avg KES 500/mo)
10-Year Vision	East African SME operating system — Kenya, Uganda, Tanzania, Rwanda

Mission

To eliminate manual business management and provide every Kenyan SME with real-time visibility into stock, sales, payments, and profitability.

Vision

To become East Africa's leading SME business operating platform by digitizing millions of daily transactions and empowering business owners with the clarity, control, and confidence they deserve.

2. THE PROBLEM — PAIN WE ARE SOLVING

Walk into any small business on Kangundo Road today and ask the owner: 'Did you make money this week?' They will pause. They will guess. Most will be wrong.

The root cause is not incompetence. It is a total absence of systems. The tools available to SMEs today are either too expensive, too complex, too Western, or simply non-existent for the Kenyan context.

Core Pain Points

1. No Real-Time Sales Tracking

- Sales are written in notebooks or remembered — neither is reliable
- End-of-day totals are often wrong or missing
- Owner cannot see what sold without manually counting stock

2. Inventory Invisibility

- Stock is managed by eye — over-ordering, under-ordering, and shrinkage go undetected
- Theft and damage are only discovered during manual stock counts, which happen rarely
- No alerts when fast-moving items run low

3. M-Pesa Reconciliation Nightmare

- Business owners receive hundreds of M-Pesa transactions weekly
- Reconciling M-Pesa statements against sales records takes hours — sometimes days
- Unrecorded payments, duplicate entries, and fraud go undetected

4. No Profitability Visibility

- Owners cannot quickly answer: 'Did I make profit today?'
- COGS vs. selling price tracking is non-existent for most
- Business decisions are made on gut feeling, not data

5. Debt and Credit Chaos

- Customer debts tracked in notebooks or via WhatsApp messages
- Debts are forgotten, under-collected, or disputed
- No systematic follow-up or aging analysis

6. Receipt and Documentation Gaps

- No professional receipts generated
- Disputes with customers over past transactions cannot be resolved
- Tax compliance is difficult without transaction records

The combined cost of these problems — in lost stock, uncollected debts, M-Pesa errors, and bad decisions — easily exceeds KES 10,000–50,000 per month for a medium-sized retail SME. Biashara OS eliminates this cost.

3. THE SOLUTION — BIASHARA OS

Biashara OS is built on a single architectural principle: everything is a transaction. Every movement of goods, every shilling received, every stock addition, every refund, every loss — all flow through a single unified transaction engine. This creates a single source of truth that powers every feature.

Transaction Types

Transaction Type	Description	Impact
Sale	Customer buys a product	Reduces inventory, increases revenue
Stock Addition	New stock received from supplier	Increases inventory, logs COGS
Payment	M-Pesa or cash received	Reconciles against sales
Refund	Product returned by customer	Reverses sale, restores stock
Adjustment	Manual stock correction	Logged with reason for audit
Loss	Expired, stolen, or damaged goods	Reduces inventory, flags for review
Damage	Broken items or packaging	Separate from loss for analytics

Platform Architecture

Transaction Engine	Core layer — every event in the business is recorded as a typed transaction
Inventory Engine	Real-time stock levels derived from transaction history — always accurate
Payment Engine	M-Pesa STK Push integration, statement import, and automatic reconciliation
Receipt Engine	Digital and printable receipts generated automatically for every sale
Reporting Engine	Real-time dashboards: daily revenue, profit margins, stock alerts, loss detection

User Modes

SELL MODE

The cashier or shop attendant view. Fast, simple POS interface. Tap item, confirm quantity, accept payment. Optimized for speed and low data usage.

STOCK MODE

The stock manager view. Add deliveries, do stock counts, flag damaged goods, check low-stock alerts. Designed for the back room.

INSIGHT MODE

The owner's view. Revenue today vs. yesterday. Best-selling items. M-Pesa reconciliation status. Loss detection. Profit margin by product. Available any time, from any device.

What We Are NOT Building (MVP Phase)

- Advanced accounting or ERP
- Payroll management
- AI or machine learning features
- Multi-branch support
- E-commerce storefront

These may become premium add-ons post-product-market fit. The MVP does one thing: makes the owner's day-to-day business visible, accurate, and manageable.

4. MARKET RESEARCH & DISCOVERY

Phase 1: Customer Discovery (Weeks 1–2)

Before writing a single line of code, the founders must conduct structured interviews with 50+ SME owners across the target verticals. The goal is to deeply understand the daily workflow of each business type — not to sell, not to demo, but to listen.

Target Businesses for Interviews

Business Type	# Interviews	Key Questions
Bars & Clubs	10	How do you track what's sold vs. what's in stock?
Liquor Stores	8	How do you reconcile M-Pesa vs. cash daily?
Retail / Dukas	10	How do you know when to reorder?
Hardware Stores	8	How do you track credit customers?
Mini-Supermarkets	6	How do you detect theft or shrinkage?
Pharmacies	5	How do you handle expiry tracking?
Agrovet Stores	5	How do you manage seasonal stock fluctuations?

Interview Script Framework

1. 'Walk me through your day from when you open to when you close.'
2. 'How do you know at end of day how much you sold?'
3. 'Show me how you check your M-Pesa — how long does that take?'
4. 'Have you ever discovered stock missing? How did you find out?'
5. 'What is the most painful part of running this business day-to-day?'
6. 'If you could have one thing that would make your business easier, what would it be?'

Phase 2: Market Research (Weeks 2–6)

Competitor Analysis

Competitor	Price Range	Weakness	Our Edge
QuickBooks / Sage	KES 3,000–15,000/mo	Too complex, not Kenya-specific	Simple, M-Pesa native

iKuze / Pesakit	Free–KES 500/mo	Limited features, poor UX	Full transaction engine
Excel / Google Sheets	Free	Manual, error-prone, no real-time	Automated, real-time
Notebooks / WhatsApp	Free	Zero data, zero insight	Everything in one place
uniCenta / Square	Free–KES 2,000/mo	Built for Western markets	Built for Kenya context

Pricing Research

Based on market benchmarks and the target customer's spending behavior:

- Most target SMEs currently spend KES 0 on business software (they use notebooks)
- Willingness to pay is highest when the product demonstrably saves them money or time within the first week
- Pricing must be framed as ROI: 'This KES 800/month will save you KES 5,000/month in losses'
- Mobile payment for subscriptions (M-Pesa) is essential — no credit cards

Market Size Calculation

TAM — Total Addressable Market	7.4M registered SMEs in Kenya (Kenya National Bureau of Statistics)
SAM — Serviceable Addressable Market	~1.2M retail/trade SMEs actively using M-Pesa for transactions
SOM — Year 1 Target	~5,000 SMEs in Nairobi East corridor; target 100 (2% capture)
SOM — Year 3 Target	~50,000 SMEs in Greater Nairobi; target 2,000 (4% capture)
SOM — Year 5 Target	~500,000 SMEs nationally; target 10,000 (2% capture)

5. VALIDATION — PROVING PEOPLE WILL PAY

Validation is the most critical phase before building. The goal is not to find people who say 'that's a great idea' — it is to find people who say 'when can I start?' and then pay a deposit.

Validation Activities

1. Live Demo Tour (Week 5–6)

- Create a clickable mockup or no-code prototype (Figma, FlutterFlow, or Glide)
- Visit 30–50 SME owners in the Kamulu/Joska corridor personally
- Demo the product on a phone — walk through a full sale, a stock count, and an M-Pesa reconciliation
- Record reactions, objections, and specific questions

2. Waiting List

- Build a simple WhatsApp waiting list — name, business type, phone number
- Target 50+ names before committing to build
- Frame it as 'early access' — creates scarcity and urgency

3. Paid Pilot Commitment

- Ask the 10 most enthusiastic prospects to pay a KES 500 refundable deposit to join the pilot
- Money on the table is the only real validation
- If nobody pays a deposit, something is wrong — revisit the pain point or pricing

Validation Success Criteria

Metric	Target	What It Proves
Businesses expressing interest	20+	There is genuine demand
Businesses agreeing to pilot	10+	People believe the product will help
Businesses paying a deposit	5+	Willingness to pay is real
Waiting list sign-ups	50+	Market is larger than pilot group

If these targets are not met within 2 weeks of demos, the team must go back to discovery and re-examine which pain point to lead with.

6. PRODUCT DESIGN & ARCHITECTURE

Design Principles

- Mobile-first: designed for a KES 8,000 Android phone on 2G/3G data
- Offline-capable: core features must work without internet, sync when connected
- Kiswahili-friendly: key labels and notifications in Kiswahili option
- Zero accounting knowledge required: no 'debit/credit', no jargon
- Instant value: a new user should see useful data within 15 minutes of setup

MVP Feature Set (Build This — Nothing Else)

Module	Features Included	Priority
Authentication	Phone number login via OTP, role-based access (owner/cashier/stockkeeper)	P0
Business Setup	Business profile, product catalog import, opening stock	P0
Products	Add/edit products, set selling price, cost price, barcode (optional)	P0
Sales / POS	Record sale, select products, quantities, calculate total, accept payment	P0
Inventory	Real-time stock levels, low-stock alerts, stock count reconciliation	P0
M-Pesa Reconciliation	M-Pesa statement import, auto-match to sales, flag unmatched	P0
Receipts	Auto-generate digital receipt per sale, shareable via WhatsApp	P1
Basic Reports	Daily sales summary, top products, cash vs M-Pesa split, profit margin	P1
Loss Tracking	Log damaged/stolen/expired items, loss report by period	P1
Debt Tracker	Record credit sales, customer balance, repayment log	P2

Technical Stack Recommendation

Mobile App	Flutter (Android-first, iOS later) — one codebase, offline support built-in
Backend API	Node.js / Express or Django REST — lightweight, fast to build
Database	PostgreSQL — relational, handles transaction volumes, audit logs
M-Pesa Integration	Safaricom Daraja API — STK Push, C2B, statement reconciliation
Hosting	AWS or DigitalOcean — Nairobi region or South Africa for latency
SMS / Notifications	Africa's Talking API — cost-effective for Kenya
Authentication	OTP via Africa's Talking + JWT sessions

7. MVP DEVELOPMENT PLAN (Weeks 7–14)

The MVP is built in two phases: a 4-week core build followed by a 2-week integration and polish sprint. The goal is a working, deployable product — not a perfect one.

Sprint Plan

Week	Sprint Goal	Deliverable
Week 7–8	Foundation	Auth, business setup, product catalog — working backend + basic app screens
Week 9–10	Core Transaction Engine	Record sale, update stock, generate receipt — end-to-end flow working
Week 11	M-Pesa Integration	STK Push payment + M-Pesa statement import + reconciliation view
Week 12	Reports & Insights	Daily sales dashboard, profit margin view, low-stock alerts
Week 13	Loss + Debt Tracking	Loss logging, debt recording, customer balance view
Week 14	Polish + Testing	Bug fixes, UX polish, offline mode testing, performance optimization

Development Team

Lead Developer	Full-stack (Node.js + Flutter) — 1 person if founder-led, or hire 1 senior dev
Mobile Developer	Flutter specialist — can be same person as lead if full-stack capable
UI/UX Designer	Part-time or freelance — design the POS and dashboard screens
QA Tester	Part-time or founder — manual testing across Android devices
M-Pesa Integration	Daraja API is well-documented — 1 developer can handle this in 1 week

Development Budget Estimate

Item	Cost (KES)	Notes
Lead Developer (2 months)	80,000–150,000	Market rate for senior Kenyan dev

Flutter/Mobile Developer	60,000–100,000	Can overlap with lead dev role
UI/UX Design (freelance)	20,000–40,000	Figma designs for all screens
Cloud Hosting (setup)	5,000–10,000	DigitalOcean or AWS first 3 months
Safaricom Daraja API	Free	No cost — sandbox and production free
Africa's Talking (SMS)	3,000–5,000	Per month, based on OTP volume
Domain + SSL	3,000–5,000	Annual
Testing Devices	10,000–20,000	2–3 low-end Android devices for testing
TOTAL ESTIMATE	181,000–330,000	Lean build with small team

8. TESTING & QUALITY ASSURANCE

Every critical bug that reaches a paying customer costs more than a sale. Testing is not optional — it is the last line of defence before real money and real businesses are on the line.

Testing Framework

Test Type	Focus Areas	Tools / Method
Functionality	All transaction types, edge cases, calculation accuracy	Manual test scripts + automated unit tests
Security	Role permissions, data isolation between businesses, audit logs	Penetration testing checklist + code review
Performance	Load testing with 100 concurrent users, response times < 2 seconds	k6 or Apache JMeter
Offline Mode	App behavior with no internet — queuing, sync on reconnect	Manual testing with airplane mode
M-Pesa Integration	Successful payment, failed payment, duplicate transaction handling	Daraja sandbox environment
Data Integrity	Stock levels after transactions, reconciliation accuracy	Automated reconciliation check scripts
User Experience	5 SME owners attempt tasks without instruction — observe friction	Usability testing sessions

Success Criteria

- Zero critical bugs (app crash, data loss, incorrect calculations) before pilot launch
- All P0 features complete and tested across at least 3 different Android device types
- M-Pesa integration tested end-to-end with real transactions in sandbox
- At least 3 non-technical SME owners can complete a full sale without assistance

9. PILOT PROGRAM (Month 4)

The pilot is the most important month in the company's history. Five to ten real businesses will use the product in their real operations. Their experience will determine whether the product is ready to scale.

Pilot Structure

Participants	5–10 businesses from the validation waiting list
Duration	30 days of active use
Support Level	Daily check-ins (WhatsApp), on-site visits Week 1 and Week 4
Pricing	Free during pilot — but pilot participants commit to pay if satisfied
Data Collection	Daily usage logs, weekly 15-minute feedback calls, NPS survey at end

What to Measure

Metric	Target	How to Measure
Daily Active Use	Business uses app every trading day	App session logs
Transactions Recorded	90%+ of sales recorded in app	Cross-check with M-Pesa statements
Retention at Day 30	70%+ still actively using	Session data
Net Promoter Score	7+ out of 10	End-of-pilot survey
Issues Reported	All critical issues resolved within 24 hours	Support log
Conversion to Paid	80%+ of pilot businesses subscribe	Subscription data

Pilot Failure Protocol

If retention falls below 50% at Day 15, immediately conduct emergency interviews with all churned businesses. Do not proceed to full launch. Go back to iteration. This is not failure — it is learning.

10. PRICING & REVENUE MODEL

Subscription Tiers

Tier	Price/Month	Target Business	Key Features
Starter	KES 300	Solo trader / kiosk	Basic POS, 50 products, daily report
Growth	KES 800	Small shop with 1–2 staff	Full POS, unlimited products, M-Pesa reconciliation, receipts
Business	KES 1,500	Medium SME with 3–10 staff	Multi-user, inventory management, loss tracking, debt tracking
Advanced	KES 5,000	Large SME / multiple categories	Advanced analytics, API access, priority support
Enterprise	Custom	Chains / franchises	Multi-branch, white-label, dedicated support, custom integrations

Setup Fees

Business Size	Setup Fee	What's Included
Small (< 100 products)	KES 500	Remote onboarding, product import, 1-hour training via video call
Medium (100–500 products)	KES 2,000	On-site setup, product import, 2-hour in-person training
Large (500+ products)	KES 10,000+	Full on-site implementation, staff training, data migration

Additional Revenue Streams

Premium Features	M-Pesa Statement Auto-Import, Advanced Loss Reports, Supplier Management — sold as add-ons
Consulting	Business process audit + optimization for established SMEs — KES 5,000–20,000 per engagement
Integrations	Future: integrate with supplier ordering systems, tax platforms (KRA iTax)

Data Insights	Anonymized industry benchmarks sold to suppliers, NGOs, financial institutions (with consent)

Revenue Growth Strategy

The path to profitability is simple: land businesses on Growth tier (KES 800/mo) and expand them to Business tier within 90 days. The Growth-to-Business upgrade is the primary upsell motion.

- Month 1–3: Focus entirely on acquisition — get to 25 paying customers
- Month 4–6: Focus on retention + upsell — upgrade 30% of Starter to Growth
- Month 7–12: Focus on expansion — referrals, new corridors, new verticals

11. GO-TO-MARKET STRATEGY

Launch Geography: Kamulu / Joska / Kangundo Road Corridor

This area is chosen deliberately. It is dense with trading activity, underserved by technology, and has strong word-of-mouth networks. A business owner here who sees a competitor using a sleek phone app to track stock will ask about it. This is how viral loops start in dense markets.

Sales Funnel

Stage	Activity	Target Conversion
Lead Generation	Walk-in visits, referrals, social media content	50 leads/month
Discovery Call	15-minute WhatsApp or in-person conversation	60% of leads → discovery
Demo	Live product demo on phone — full sale + M-Pesa reconciliation	50% of discovery → demo
Trial	7-day free trial with setup included	70% of demo → trial
Subscription	Convert trial to paid plan	60% of trial → paid
Referral	Happy customer refers 1 other business	30% of customers → referral

Offline Channels (Primary at Launch)

Walk-Ins (Direct Sales)

The founder personally visits businesses in the target corridor. No appointment needed. Walk in, introduce the product, ask to show a 5-minute demo. This is how the first 25 customers are won — through founder-led sales, not advertising.

Referral Program

Every customer who refers a new paying customer receives one month free. This is the most cost-effective acquisition channel in tight-knit trading communities.

Business Associations

Partner with local business associations, chamas, and market groups in the target area. Offer group rates and group demos. One presentation to 20 business owners is worth 20 individual visits.

Online Channels (Month 3+)

Channel	Content Type	Posting Frequency	Goal
TikTok	Before/after videos: 'This is how James used to track stock [shows notebook] → now [shows app]'	3x/week	Awareness + viral reach
Facebook	Business tips, testimonials, educational posts about M-Pesa reconciliation	Daily	Leads + community
Instagram	Visual success stories, product screenshots, infographics	4x/week	Brand + credibility
WhatsApp Business	Broadcast lists to prospects, support channel, update announcements	As needed	Conversion + retention
YouTube	Product demos, how-to tutorials, business education	1x/week	SEO + trust-building

Content Strategy

- Show real businesses, real problems, real results — not stock photography
- Kiswahili content outperforms English for this audience — mix both
- Educational content builds trust before selling: 'How to know if your shop is profitable'
- Testimonial videos from pilot businesses — a bar owner explaining how he found a KES 15,000 discrepancy in his first week

12. OPERATIONS & CUSTOMER SUCCESS

Customer Onboarding Process

Step	Activity	Owner	Time
1	Sales call confirms plan and setup fee	Founder / Sales	30 min
2	M-Pesa payment received, account created	System / Founder	5 min
3	Product catalog import (CSV or manual)	Founder / Onboarding	30–60 min
4	Opening stock count set in system	Business owner + Founder	60–90 min
5	Staff trained on SELL MODE and STOCK MODE	Founder	60 min
6	First day check-in via WhatsApp	Founder	15 min
7	Day 7 in-app or WhatsApp usage review	Founder	30 min
8	Month 1 retention call — feedback + upsell discussion	Founder	30 min

Support Model

Primary Support Channel	WhatsApp Business — respond within 2 hours (6am–10pm)
Escalation Channel	Phone call for urgent issues (app down, data discrepancy)
Community Support	WhatsApp group with all customers — peer support + product updates
Issue Resolution SLA	Critical bugs: 4 hours | Feature requests: logged + roadmap update
Monthly Business Review	30-minute call with every Business/Advanced tier customer

Key Operational Metrics

- Churn Rate: target < 5% monthly (industry average for B2B SaaS in Africa: 3–8%)
- Net Promoter Score (NPS): target 40+ within 6 months
- First Response Time: < 2 hours on WhatsApp

- Time to First Value: < 15 minutes from signup to first recorded transaction
- Monthly Active Rate: > 85% of paid customers active in any 30-day period

13. FINANCIAL PROJECTIONS

Revenue Assumptions

- Average Revenue Per User (ARPU): KES 500/month (blended across tiers)
- Setup fee average: KES 1,200 per new customer
- Monthly churn: 4% (industry standard for Kenya SME SaaS)
- Net new customers added per month grows as sales team scales

5-Year Revenue Projections

Year	Businesses	Avg MRR/Customer	Monthly Revenue	Annual Revenue
Year 1	100	KES 500	KES 50,000	KES 600,000
Year 2	500	KES 500	KES 250,000	KES 3,000,000
Year 3	2,000	KES 500	KES 1,000,000	KES 12,000,000
Year 4	5,000	KES 550	KES 2,750,000	KES 33,000,000
Year 5	10,000	KES 600	KES 6,000,000	KES 72,000,000

Monthly Cost Structure (Year 1)

Cost Category	Monthly Cost (KES)	Notes
Cloud Hosting	8,000–15,000	Scales with user growth
M-Pesa / SMS APIs	3,000–5,000	Variable by transaction volume
Customer Support	0–20,000	Founder-led initially, then hire
Sales / Marketing	10,000–30,000	Content creation, transport for demos
Software Tools	3,000–5,000	WhatsApp Business API, design tools
Contingency (10%)	2,400–7,500	Buffer for unexpected costs
TOTAL MONTHLY OPEX	26,400–82,500	Lean operation in Year 1

Break-Even Analysis

At a monthly opex of KES 50,000 and an ARPU of KES 500, the break-even point is 100 paying customers. This is the Year 1 goal — and it is achievable within 10–12 months of launch with consistent founder-led sales.

Unit Economics

Customer Acquisition Cost (CAC)	KES 1,500–3,000 (founder time + transport + demo costs)
Average Revenue Per User (ARPU)	KES 500/month
Gross Margin	~80% (SaaS model — low marginal cost per customer)
Customer Lifetime Value (LTV)	KES 500 × 24 months avg retention = KES 12,000
LTV:CAC Ratio	~5:1 to 8:1 — healthy SaaS benchmark is 3:1+
Payback Period	3–6 months per customer

14. SCALING STRATEGY

Geographic Expansion Stages

Stage	Timeline	Geography	Milestone
Stage 0 — Pilot	Month 1–4	Kamulu / Joska / Kangundo Rd	10 pilot businesses, 70% retention
Stage 1 — Local Launch	Month 5–12	East Nairobi (Eastlands, Embakasi, Ruai)	100 paying customers
Stage 2 — Greater Nairobi	Year 2	All Nairobi sub-counties	500 paying customers
Stage 3 — Nairobi Metro	Year 2–3	Kiambu, Machakos, Kajiado, Murang'a	1,000 paying customers
Stage 4 — Major Cities	Year 3–4	Mombasa, Kisumu, Nakuru, Eldoret, Thika	2,000 paying customers
Stage 5 — National Kenya	Year 4–5	All major Kenyan urban centres	5,000 paying customers
Stage 6 — East Africa	Year 5+	Uganda, Tanzania, Rwanda	10,000 paying customers

Scaling Levers

1. Field Sales Team

From Month 6, begin hiring commission-based field sales agents. Each agent targets a specific geographic cluster. Target: 1 agent per area, each closing 10–15 new customers per month.

2. Channel Partners

Partner with phone shops, internet cafes, and business supply stores in target areas. Train them to demo and refer Biashara OS. Pay a referral commission per converted customer.

3. WhatsApp Virality

Every receipt generated by the app includes a subtle 'Powered by Biashara OS' tagline sent to the customer via WhatsApp. Customers become brand ambassadors passively.

4. Vertical Depth

After product-market fit in retail, launch vertical-specific packs: Pharmacy Pack (expiry tracking), Bar Pack (liquor license compliance), Hardware Pack (credit customer management). Each vertical pack commands a 20–30% price premium.

Team Scaling Plan

Hire	Timing	Role	Impact
Customer Success Agent	Month 6	Handle support, onboarding, retention calls	Frees founder for sales
Field Sales Agent #1	Month 8	Dedicated sales in East Nairobi	Adds 10–15 customers/month
Developer #2	Month 10	Feature development, bug fixes, infrastructure	Reduces founder's tech load
Field Sales Agent #2–3	Year 2 Q1	Expand to Greater Nairobi	Accelerate customer growth
Marketing Manager	Year 2 Q2	Own social media, content, partnerships	Reduce CAC through organic
Head of Engineering	Year 3	Lead technical team of 3–5 developers	Support regional scale
Country Manager (Uganda)	Year 5	Lead expansion into Uganda market	First regional market

15. RISK MANAGEMENT

Risk	Likelihood	Impact	Mitigation
Competition from larger players	Medium	High	Focus on local depth, M-Pesa-native UX, personal service competitors cannot replicate
Customer churn due to product complexity	High	High	Ruthless simplicity in design; onboarding support; daily retention monitoring
M-Pesa API downtime	Medium	High	Offline mode for core features; automatic retry queue; user notifications
Data loss / server failure	Low	Critical	Daily automated backups to separate region; disaster recovery plan tested quarterly
Security breach / data theft	Low	Critical	End-to-end encryption; role-based access; penetration testing before launch
Founder burnout	Medium	High	Hire customer success by Month 6; establish SOPs early; delegate before it becomes urgent
Slow customer acquisition	Medium	Medium	Pivot to referral incentives; adjust pricing; explore channel partnerships earlier
Regulatory changes (M-Pesa API)	Low	High	Monitor Safaricom developer communications; build abstraction layer over API
Poor product-market fit	Low-Medium	Critical	Do not skip discovery and validation phases; talk to 50+ customers before building

16. SYSTEMIZATION & DELEGATION

The goal of systemization is to make the business function without the founder's daily involvement. This is how a startup becomes a company.

Standard Operating Procedures (SOPs) to Build

SOP	When to Build	Owner
Customer Onboarding SOP	Before pilot launch	Founder
Sales Demo Script	Before first demo	Founder
Support Response Templates	Before pilot launch	Founder
Bug Escalation Process	Before pilot launch	Tech Lead
Monthly Review Call Script	Month 3	Founder / CS Agent
Billing and Dunning Process	Month 2	Founder → automate
New Market Entry Playbook	Before Stage 2 expansion	Founder + Sales Lead
Staff Training Manual	Month 6	CS Agent

Delegation Timeline

- Month 1–5: Founder does everything — sales, support, development coordination, billing
- Month 6: Hire Customer Success Agent — delegate all tier 1 support and onboarding
- Month 8: Hire first Field Sales Agent — delegate new customer acquisition in defined territory
- Month 10: Hire Developer #2 — delegate day-to-day bug fixes and minor features
- Year 2: Hire Marketing Manager — delegate all content, social, and community management
- Year 3: Founder role shifts to strategy, partnerships, fundraising, and product vision

17. LONG-TERM VISION & FUTURE PRODUCT ROADMAP

The 10-Year Vision

Biashara OS becomes the operating system for SME Africa. Every transaction. Every shilling. Every business. When an entrepreneur in Kampala, Dar es Salaam, or Kigali opens a shop, they start with Biashara OS the same way a Kenyan might start with M-Pesa. It is the default.

Future Product Modules (Post Product-Market Fit)

Module	Timeline	Revenue Model	Description
M-Pesa Statement Auto-Import	Year 1 Q3	Included in Business tier	Automated pull of M-Pesa business statements for instant reconciliation
Supplier Management	Year 2 Q1	Add-on KES 500/mo	Track supplier invoices, payment terms, delivery schedules
Customer CRM	Year 2 Q2	Add-on KES 300/mo	Customer profiles, purchase history, loyalty tracking
Payroll Module	Year 2 Q3	Add-on KES 800/mo	Basic salary + commission tracking; M-Pesa bulk payout integration
AI Sales Insights	Year 3 Q1	Premium tier feature	Predict fast-moving items, flag slow stock, suggest optimal reorder quantities
Demand Forecasting	Year 3 Q2	Advanced tier feature	ML-based seasonal demand prediction by product category
E-commerce Integration	Year 3 Q3	Revenue share model	Connect Biashara OS inventory to online storefronts (Jiji, social commerce)
KRA iTax Integration	Year 4	Enterprise feature	Automatic tax filing preparation from transaction records
Regional Multi-Currency	Year 5	Enterprise feature	Support UGX, TZS, RWF for East Africa expansion

Regional Expansion Countries

Country	Entry Year	Strategy	Key Differentiator
Kenya (home)	Year 1	Founder-led ground-up sales	M-Pesa native, Kiswahili UX
Uganda	Year 5	Partner with local agent network	MTN Mobile Money integration, Luganda UX
Tanzania	Year 5–6	Partner with Dar es Salaam-based distributor	M-Pesa TZ + Airtel Money integration
Rwanda	Year 6–7	Government SME digitization program partnership	MoMo Pay integration, Kinyarwanda UX

18. MASTER TIMELINE — ZERO TO REGIONAL

Phase	Timeline	Key Activities	Success Milestone
Discovery	Week 1–2	50+ SME interviews across 7 verticals	10 recurring pain points identified
Market Research	Week 2–6	Competitor analysis, pricing research, TAM/SAM/SOM	100 businesses surveyed, pricing validated
Validation	Week 5–7	Live demos, waiting list, 5 deposit-paying pilots confirmed	5 businesses pay KES 500 deposit
Business Planning	Week 6–8	Finalize pricing, unit economics, go-to-market plan	Business plan complete
Product Design	Week 7–9	Full UX wireframes, architecture spec, API design	Design approved by 3 pilot businesses
MVP Development	Week 9–16	8-week build sprint — auth, POS, inventory, M-Pesa, reports	Working app on Android
Testing	Week 15–17	Functional, security, performance, UX testing	Zero critical bugs
Pilot Program	Month 4	5–10 real businesses using live product for 30 days	70%+ retention at Day 30
Iteration	Month 5	Fix friction, remove confusion, address feedback	NPS 7+, top bugs resolved
Launch	Month 5–6	First 25 paying customers in Kamulu/Joska corridor	KES 15,000 MRR
Expand East Nairobi	Month 7–12	Field sales, referral program, content marketing	100 paying customers, KES 50,000 MRR
Greater Nairobi	Year 2	2 field agents, marketing manager, referral velocity	500 customers, KES 250,000 MRR
National Kenya	Year 3–4	City-by-city expansion, channel partners	2,000–5,000 customers
East Africa	Year 5+	Uganda, Tanzania, Rwanda entry	10,000 customers, KES 6M MRR

19. SUCCESS METRICS — WHAT TO MEASURE AND WHEN

North Star Metric

Monthly Active Businesses — the number of businesses that record at least one transaction in the platform per month. This is the single number that tells us if the product is working.

Metric Dashboard by Stage

Stage	Primary Metric	Target	Secondary Metrics
Discovery	Interviews completed	50+	# pain points confirmed, % naming same top 3
Validation	Deposit-paying pilots	5+	Demo conversion rate, waiting list size
MVP Build	Features shipped on time	100% P0 by Week 14	Bug count, test coverage
Pilot	Day-30 retention	70%+	Daily active use, NPS, transactions/day
Launch	Paying customers	25 by Month 6	MRR, churn rate, CAC
Growth	MRR	KES 50,000 by Month 12	Net new customers, expansion revenue, LTV:CAC
Scale	Businesses on platform	2,000 by Year 3	ARR, gross margin, team productivity
Regional	Multi-country businesses	10,000 by Year 5	Revenue per country, NPS per market

20. FOUNDING PHILOSOPHY

Do not build features.

Solve business pain.

Do not sell software.

Sell clarity, control, and confidence.

Every transaction recorded.
Every shilling accounted for.
Every business understood.

Biashara OS — The Operating System for Kenyan SMEs